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Unit- 7:

Self-perception & Self-concept

1. SELF-CONCEPT

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- Self is elusive (not tangible) & can be defined variously
- May defined as a person's unique dimensions, potentials, and purposes
- Self-concept is mental image of one self;
- A person's meaning when stated as "I" or "Me";
- Frame of reference that influences how one handles life situations and relationships.
- It is dynamic and influenced by experiences and expectations.
- A sound self-concept is prerequisite for mental health

X-tics of Normal Self-Concept

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- Clear sense of self and others
- Ability to distinguish self as separate individual
- Ability to acknowledge self strengths, weaknesses, and emotions/feelings
- Realistic view of others
- Ability to relate to people in a satisfying, intimate, and loving manner
- Ability to deal with realities and problems of life with appropriate coping behaviors

2. SELF-PERCEPTION

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- It is a filtering process that evaluates events and enters them into subconscious (hidden mind)
- It prevents feelings of guilt, anxiety, and unworthiness from surfacing (developing)

Dimensions of Self-perception

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- ❑ ***Self-knowledge (self awareness):***
- ❑ Cognitive process which involves basic understanding of one self.
- ❑ It includes consciousness of one's abilities like cognitive, affective, and physical abilities.
- ❑ It also involves basic facts (age, weight, sex...) and qualities (sincere, intelligence...) of oneself related to who one is.

- ❑ ***Self-expectation:***
- ❑ Involves ideal self- the self a person wants to be
- ❑ It includes setting of goals for present and future and based on limits of person's awareness
- ❑ It may be attainable (if realistic) or not and influenced by significant others like mother, spouse, friends, etc.

□ Social self:

- It is how one sees one self in relation to social situations and includes behaviors and interaction with others
- One can never fully know how people (others) see oneself, but can only guess (which may be far from reality)
- People tend to hide their true self in social obligations

- ❑ ***Self-evaluation:***
- ❑ It is conscious assessment of self and leads to self-respect or self-worth.
- ❑ It is the way one appreciate (look) one's physical appearance, knowledge, and your entire act and involves self-esteem.

Normal Functional Self-concept Patterns

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Positive body image:

- Body *image* is how one pictures one's *body* and feels about one's body
- It is a unifying concept behind feeling about one's body size, shape, appearance, sex, and sexuality
- Human body is physical manifestation of self in the real world
- Body image is influenced by culture and social experiences

Self-esteem:

- Judgment one makes regarding one's self.
- It is a result of self-evaluation of worth.
- It is affective in nature and made up of thoughts and feelings.
- Its two main sources are self and others

Self-concept Patterns....

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- Antecedents (fundamentals) of high self-esteem are: parental acceptance, clear expectations, limitations, and freedom to express opinions
- Core self-esteem is the person's consistent overall appraisal (evaluation) of self
- Persons with high self-esteem accept others, experience less anxiety, functions effectively in social situations

Criteria for self-appraisal are:

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- ▣ **Power:** ability to influence people and events;
- ▣ **Meaning:** the sense of being valued and worth;
- ▣ **Competence:** ability to achieve personal goals
- ▣ **Virtue:** behaving in a manner consistent with personal values (moral and ethical standards)

Strong personal identity:

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- ***Identity*** is organizing principles of self.
- It is the awareness that one is a distinct individual separate from others.
- Strong sense of personal identity contributes to integrated self-esteem, body image, and various roles into integrated whole self.
- Personal identity depends on intact body boundaries (this is my hand; this is your hand) and ego boundaries (this is my feeling; not your thought)

□ **Role performance:**

- Role is the expected X-tics behavior of a person in a social position.
- ***Roles can be ascribed or assumed***
- ***Ascribed roles:*** roles a person hold without choice (e.g. being son or daughter).
- ***Assumed roles:*** roles a person holds based on his personal preference (e.g. being father, mother, nurse)
- Roles overlap and a person must combine many roles to achieve a unified pattern of functioning.

Factors Affecting Normal Self- concept

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- ❑ **Biologic make up:** height, weight, skin color, and attractiveness or unattractiveness are biological factors that can affect self-concept
- ❑ They are self-perceived and perceived by others
- ❑ **Culture, values and beliefs:** during growth individuals internalize the culture, values and beliefs to which they are exposed

- ❑ **Coping and stress tolerance:** people able to adapt to stress and resolve conflicts through coping tend to develop healthy self-concept.
- ❑ **Previous experience:** opportunities for success and failure are among experiences that can affect self-concept. Success produce feeling of self-esteem and give hope to further expect success w/r as failure may cause the opposite

- ❑ **Developmental level:** Developmental stages can reinforce or alter self-concept
- ❑ Accomplishment of tasks at each developmental stage enhances self-concept
- ❑ **Illness:** Positive self-concept is usually based on healthy self
- ❑ Acute or chronic illness, trauma, or surgery can adversely affect self-esteem and body image and hence self-concept.

Potentials For Altered Self-concept

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- ❖ **Stressful life events:** Financial difficulties, problems related to job, r/ship concerns, sexuality concerns, divorce, loss of loved one, etc are among the stressful life events.
- They challenge person's identity and self-esteem, and may paralyze the person and damage self-concept.
- ❖ **Inadequate coping:** Lack of support system and inability to prioritize and solve problems may cause inadequate coping w/c leads to self-concept dysfunction

- ❖ **Incomplete developmental tasks:** Adolescence is particularly, a difficult time due to many changes like physical, emotional and sexual changes occur.
- Body image and identity are not secure.
- ❖ **Role transitions:** Multiple role transitions occur during life time.
- Two types of role transitions are:
 1. **Dev'tal role transition**
 2. **Situational role transition**

- 1. Dev'tal role transition-** associated with growth and aging, e.g. transition from student to wage earner

- 2. Situational role transition-** associated with changes in relationships, e.g. changes in status from single to married, from married to widowed, etc.

- ❖ **Illness, trauma, and surgery:** Produces stress, role strain, reduced self-esteem, and altered body image, e.g. loss of body part.
- Amputation, mastectomy, burns, and facial trauma cause significant change in body structures and appearance.
- Cardiac and renal diseases can also affect self-concept.

Manifestations Of Altered Self Concept

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- ***Self-care deficit:*** Include unwillingness to take medications, disregarding special diet instructions, not keeping follow up appointments, poor personal hygiene, lack of health seeking behavior, etc.
- ***Anxiety and depression:*** Common psychological manifestations of self-concept dysfunction.
- ***Self-destructive behavior:*** Manifested through substance abuse (alcohol, drug), sexual promiscuity, gambling, over eating
- They only numb the pain of self hatred

- **Emotional and behavioral changes:**
 - **Emotional changes** are feeling of depersonalization, hopelessness, helplessness, alienation, fear of rejection, anger, sadness, shame, guilt, worthlessness, etc.
 - **Behavioral changes** are lack of interest in activities, inability to make decisions, isolation, refusing to look at self in mirror, refusal to make eye contact, negative verbalization about self, withdrawal from social situations

Application of Nursing Process

Assessment: Subjective Data

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- ***Functional pattern identification: Ask questions about self concept like:***
 - How would you describe yourself?
 - Most of time, how do you feel about yourself?
 - Are you experiencing changes in the way you feel about yourself?
 - Do you find things frequently make you feel angry, anxious, frustrated, afraid, or sad? If so what helps?

- **Risk identification:** Consider the following about the patient during risk assessment:
 - ▣ Developmental stages
 - ▣ Previous experience
 - ▣ Intensity of the stressor or threat
 - ▣ Self-expectations
 - ▣ Assess difference b/n real self and ideal self

- ❑ ***Dysfunction identification:*** Assess the following:
 - ❑ Patient's thought and feelings
 - ❑ Feelings of inferiority, self-doubt, and self-dislike
 - ❑ Whether the problem is with self-esteem, role function, personal identity, or body image

Assessment: Objective Data

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- ***Observe the following during your physical assessment:***
 - Behavioral manifestations as refusing eye contact
 - A missing body part or function
 - Concealed (covered, hidden) body part
 - Anxious behaviors such as hand-wringing, shallow breathing, etc
 - Grief behaviors such as weeping

Nursing Diagnoses

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1. Body image disturbance

- ***Definition:*** disruption in the way one perceives one's body image
- ***Defining characteristics:*** Verbal responses to actual or perceived change in structure and/or function e.g. verbalization of change in life style, fear of rejection, etc; Non verbal responses like not looking at body part, hiding or over exposing body part, etc.
- ***Related factors:*** biophysical, cognitive/perceptual, psychological, cultural or spiritual factors.

2. Self-esteem disturbance

- **Definition:** negative self-evaluation/feelings about self or self capabilities
- **Defining characteristics:** negative self verbalization, expression of shame/guilt, evaluating self as unable to deal with events, rejects positive feedbacks and exaggerates negative feedbacks about self, hesitancy to try new things/situations, etc

3. Personal identity disturbance

- **Definition:** inability to distinguish b/n self and non self

4. *Altered role performance*

- *Definition*: disruption in the way one perceives one's role performance
- *Defining characteristics*: denial role, conflict in roles, lack of knowledge of role, change in usual pattern of responsibility, change in physical capability to resume role, etc
- **Related nursing diagnoses**: Anxiety; Ineffective individual/family coping; Fear; Altered family process; Anticipatory grief; Hopelessness; Powerlessness; Social isolation; Altered thought process

Nursing Interventions

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- ***Nursing interventions to promote health and functions of self-concept***
 - ▣ Identifying patient strengths and promotion through support
 - ▣ Promoting sense of self in patient
 - ▣ Promote development of self-concept

- ***Nursing interventions for altered self-concept***
 - ▣ Creating therapeutic relationship with the patient
 - ▣ Promoting positive self-evaluation of the patient
 - ▣ Promoting behavioral change

Thank you!!

